# 3 Creating a New Rails Project

The best way to use this guide is to follow each step as it happens, no code or step needed to make this example application has been left out, so you can literally follow along step by step.

By following along with this guide, you'll create a Rails project called `blog`, a (very) simple weblog. Before you can start building the application, you need to make sure that you have Rails itself installed.
The examples below use `$` to represent your terminal prompt in a UNIX-like OS, though it may have been customized to appear differently. If you are using Windows, your prompt will look something like `c:\source_code>`

## 3.1 Installing Rails

Open up a command line prompt. On Mac OS X open Terminal.app, on Windows choose "Run" from your Start menu and type 'cmd.exe'. Any commands prefaced with a dollar sign `$` should be run in the command line. Verify that you have a current version of Ruby installed:
A number of tools exist to help you quickly install Ruby and Ruby on Rails on your system. Windows users can use Rails Installer, while Mac OS X users can use Tokaido. For more installation methods for most Operating Systems take a look at ruby-lang.org.

```
$ ruby -v
ruby 2.0.0p353
```

Many popular UNIX-like OSes ship with an acceptable version of SQLite3. On Windows, if you installed Rails through Rails Installer, you already have SQLite installed. Others can find installation instructions at the SQLite3 website. Verify that it is correctly installed and in your PATH:

```
$ sqlite3 --version
```

The program should report its version.

To install Rails, use the `gem install` command provided by RubyGems:

```
$ gem install rails
```

To verify that you have everything installed correctly, you should be able to run the following:

```
$ rails --version
```

If it says something like "Rails 5.0.0", you are ready to continue.

## 3.2 Creating the Blog Application

Rails comes with a number of scripts called generators that are designed to make your development life easier by creating everything that's necessary to start working on a particular task. One of these is the new application generator, which will provide you with the foundation of a fresh Rails application so that you don't have to write it yourself.

To use this generator, open a terminal, navigate to a directory where you have rights to create files, and type:

```
$ rails new blog
```

This will create a Rails application called Blog in a `blog` directory and install the gem dependencies that are already mentioned in `Gemfile` using `bundle install`.
You can see all of the command line options that the Rails application builder accepts by running `rails new -h`.